



FIND MY TABLE

TABLE READY

Session Zero & Group Compatibility Kit

Spot mismatches early. Build a table people can actually keep.

SYSTEM-NEUTRAL

Print or type notes • 30–45 minute guided conversation

FOR HOSTS FORMING A NEW OR MIXED GROUP

Compare schedule, commitment, play style, boundaries, access needs, and venue format — then make one clear decision before the campaign begins.

A good outcome includes “not this table.”

This kit is a decision aid, not a compatibility score. Use it before a campaign, recurring game night, or paid table.

1

Complete

Each person fills pages 3–9 privately or in quiet time.

2

Compare

Share only what you choose. A boundary needs no explanation.

3

Map

The host records alignment and mismatches on pages 10–11.

4

Agree

Write specific owners, dates, and rules on page 12.

5

Decide

Choose READY, READY WITH CHANGES, or NOT THIS TABLE.

6

Review

Check after session one and after 30 days.

GROUND RULES

- Circumstances can change; update the agreement.
- Do not pressure anyone to explain a boundary or access need.
- One critical mismatch can matter more than ten matches.
- “We’ll figure it out” is unresolved without an owner and date.

My player snapshot

Complete this for yourself. Share only the parts needed to decide whether the table is workable.

Name or table name

Pronouns optional

Preferred contact method

☐ I confirm I meet the table's stated age requirement

☐ New to TTRPGs

☐ Some experience

☐ Very experienced

Systems or genres I want to try

Systems, formats, or genres I do not want

Languages I can comfortably play in

A great session feels like...

What usually makes me stop attending...

Schedule reality

Write the schedule you can keep, not the schedule you wish you could keep.

Timezone / usual location

☐ Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu
☐ Fri ☐ Sat ☐ Sun

Earliest start / latest finish

☐ Weekly ☐ Every 2 weeks ☐ Monthly
☐ One-shot only ☐ Flexible

Preferred session length / earliest start date

Commitment window or expected end date

Known blackout dates / travel constraints

Minimum cancellation notice I can give

If I am late or absent, the group may...

My non-negotiable schedule constraint

Format, venue & access

A workable table includes the practical conditions people need to participate.

☐ Online

☐ Public venue

☐ Private venue only by explicit agreement

☐ Hybrid

Travel radius / transport / parking

Platform, camera, microphone, text-chat, or caption needs

Seating, stairs, restroom, break, noise, light, or sensory needs

Food, allergy, service-animal, alcohol, or smoking considerations

Maximum spend per session, including venue/food

☐ Share with full group

☐ Share with host only

☐ Ask me privately before sharing

Host follow-up needed before I can commit

The game promise

The host completes this before asking players to commit.

System / campaign or one-shot / genre

Tone and content level in one sentence

Expected arc, session count, and ending condition

Character creation constraints / rules approach / homebrew

Failure, character loss, and difficulty expectations

Prep, homework, technology, or source ownership required

☐ No recording

☐ Private recording

☐ Public stream/clips

☐ AI-assisted material disclosed

Price, payment timing, and refund rule — if any

Explicitly excluded from this game

Play-style compass

Circle one number on each line. A difference is a discussion prompt, not a bad score.

One end	Preference	Other end
Tactical challenge	1 2 3 4 5	Freeform story
Serious consequences	1 2 3 4 5	Light / casual
GM-led direction	1 2 3 4 5	Player-led exploration
Rules as written	1 2 3 4 5	Flexible rulings
Long character scenes	1 2 3 4 5	Fast scene changes
Shared spotlight	1 2 3 4 5	Competitive edge
Planned campaign	1 2 3 4 5	Improvised sandbox
High difficulty	1 2 3 4 5	Comfort-forward

My three must-haves

My three flex points

One play-style deal-breaker

Commitment & communication

Make reliability and conflict expectations visible before they become personal.

Arrival standard / cancellation notice / repeated no-show response

Between-game channel / response-time expectation

Who schedules / how the group makes decisions

How I prefer to receive feedback or resolve conflict

☐ Devices okay

☐ Devices for play only

☐ Side chat okay

☐ Guests by agreement

☐ No photos

☐ Photos by consent

Payment deadline / refund rule / exit path — if applicable

The reliability promise I can honestly make

Boundaries without interrogation

Mark privately. A person may change an answer at any time and never has to explain a boundary.

Topic	OK	ASK	FADE	NO	PRIVATE
Graphic violence	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Harm to children	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Sexual content	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Romance	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Prejudice	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Body horror	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Illness / medical	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Grief / death	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Phobias	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Loss of control	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Player-v-player	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Secrets / betrayal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Substance use	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Religion / cults	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Real-world politics	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Other: _____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

OK = okay to include • ASK = ask privately first • FADE = imply or skip detail • NO = do not include • PRIVATE = tell host only

Pause & repair protocol

A worksheet reduces ambiguity; it cannot guarantee safety or replace qualified safeguarding.

Words or signals anyone may use to pause immediately

Private check-in method during play

When someone pauses, the table will...

Who follows up after a harmful or uncomfortable moment

What stays confidential / what may need escalation

Local, venue, platform, or professional rule that overrides this page

If a credible safety concern appears, stop the activity and use the appropriate local, venue, platform, emergency, or professional process. Do not use this kit to investigate or adjudicate harm.

Compatibility at a glance

The host records the group pattern. “Workable” requires a specific change, owner, and date.

Area	Aligned	Change	Open	Owner	Due
Schedule	■	■	■		
Frequency	■	■	■		
Format / location	■	■	■		
Cost	■	■	■		
System / genre	■	■	■		
Tone / content	■	■	■		
Play style	■	■	■		
Commitment	■	■	■		
Communication	■	■	■		
Boundaries	■	■	■		
Accessibility	■	■	■		
Recording / privacy	■	■	■		

The one mismatch most likely to break this table

Make the change concrete

Do not solve a boundary by asking the person with the boundary to absorb the cost.

MISMATCH 1

What differs / why it matters

Smallest change / owner / due date

Trial period / success signal / fallback

MISMATCH 2

What differs / why it matters

Smallest change / owner / due date

Trial period / success signal / fallback

MISMATCH 3

What differs / why it matters

Smallest change / owner / due date

Trial period / success signal / fallback

☐ Voluntary

☐ Specific

☐ Reversible where possible

☐ No explanation demanded

☐ No one isolated

☐ Real owner/resource

Our table agreement

Keep only what the group agreed to share. Delete private working notes when they are no longer needed.

Game promise

Schedule / location / platform

Attendance / cancellation

Communication / decisions

Rules / spotlight / devices

Pause / boundaries / access

Recording / privacy

Payment / refund — if any

Conflict / exit path

Review date

Participants acknowledge that this agreement is current, voluntary, and revisable. It is not a waiver of anyone's rights or a guarantee of safety or attendance.

Choose clearly

A respectful no is better than a campaign held together by unspoken assumptions.

- ☐ READY — critical needs align
- ☐ READY WITH CHANGES — conditions recorded
- ☐ NOT THIS TABLE — close respectfully

Decision reason / required changes

Next action / owner / date

Private confidence (0–10) / strongest reason

What experience or proof would change this decision

- ☐ Check after session one
- ☐ Check after 30 days
- ☐ Check after material change

Review notes

Facilitate; do not diagnose

Keep the conversation specific, private where needed, and easy to leave.

BEFORE

Send pages 3–10. Offer a private-response route. State exact format, cost, and limitations. Do not promise universal fit.

DURING

Start with schedule and cost. Summarize rather than interpret. Separate preferences, needs, and hard conditions. Let anyone pass.

CLOSE

Read the agreement. Ask private confidence. Name unresolved items. Make READY / CHANGES / NOT THIS TABLE explicit.

AFTER

Share only the agreed record. Delete private notes. Review after the first session and 30 days. Record changes.

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